

IN THE UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE

Application No.	19/198,051
Applicant	Dan et al.
Examiner	Hassan A. Hussein
Art Unit	2497
Confirmation No.	7644
Office Action	Mailed 30 June 2026
Attorney Docket	600276-0001-US

RESPONSE TO NON-FINAL OFFICE ACTION

DRAFT - INCOMPLETE. The claim set for this application was not available when this draft was prepared. A response under § 1.111 must include a complete listing of all claims with status identifiers; the listing below is limited to claim 1, reconstructed from the Examiner's quotation in the Office Action, together with the claims requiring typographical correction. Claims 2-25 must be inserted verbatim before filing. The amendment to claim 1 further assumes that this specification supports agentless interrogation; if it does not, the agentless clause must be deleted. The arguments in sections III and IV do not depend upon it.

Sir or Madam:

In response to the Office Action mailed 30 June 2026, please amend the above-identified application as set forth below and reconsider the application in view of the following remarks. Claims 1-25 are pending.

AMENDMENTS TO THE SPECIFICATION

Please replace the Abstract with the substitute abstract submitted on a separate sheet herewith. The substitute abstract is in narrative form, is within 50 to 150 words, is presented on a separate sheet apart from any other text, and does not use the language to which the Examiner objected. The objection under MPEP § 608.01(b) is thereby addressed.

AMENDMENTS TO THE CLAIMS

Added text is shown by underlining; deleted text is shown by ~~striketrough~~. **Claims 2-25 to be inserted in full before filing.**

1. (Currently amended) A computer implemented method for protecting at least one or more databases installed on one or more servers from security threats, the method comprising: interrogating the one or more databases by a monitoring database installed on a monitoring server to identify security threats to the one or more databases, wherein the interrogating is performed in an agentless manner, without installing a monitoring agent on the one or more servers on which the one or more databases are installed; [remaining limitations of claim 1 as filed]; and neutralizing an identified security threat while the identified security threat is occurring, by dynamically altering a structure of a client SQL statement of a connection associated with the identified security threat, such that operation of a client of the connection is delayed.

7. (Currently amended) [Claim 7 as filed, amended to delete ~~the~~ before “result” and ~~its~~ before “assigned”.]

10. (Currently amended) [Claim 10 as filed, amended to delete ~~the~~ before “owner” or to supply antecedent basis.]

18. (Currently amended) [Claim 18 as filed, amended to delete ~~the~~ before “result” and ~~its~~ before “assigned”.]

20. (Currently amended) A computer program product comprising a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium having computer-executable instructions for [remaining limitations as filed].

25. (Currently amended) [Claim 25 as filed, amended to correct ~~interogation~~ to interrogation, and to delete ~~the~~ before “result” and ~~its~~ before “assigned”.]

REMARKS

Claims 1-25 are pending and stand rejected. By this amendment the Examiner’s objections to the specification and to claims 7, 10, 18 and 25 are addressed, claim 20 is amended to recite a non-transitory medium, and the independent claims are amended to recite an agentless architecture and an active neutralization step. Reconsideration is respectfully requested.

I. Objections to the specification and to claims 7, 10, 18 and 25

A substitute abstract is submitted herewith. The informalities identified in claims 7, 18 and 25, in claim 10, and the misspelling in claim 25 are corrected as set out above. Withdrawal of the

objections is respectfully requested.

II. Rejection of claims 20-25 under 35 U.S.C. § 101

Claim 20 is amended to recite a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, in accordance with the Examiner's suggestion and consistent with the specification. Withdrawal of this rejection is respectfully requested.

III. Rejection of claims 1-8 and 10-25 under 35 U.S.C. § 103 over Miller in view of Gupta

A. Gupta requires the very agent that the claims exclude. Gupta (US 2016/0337400, Virsec Systems) detects SQL injection by constructing a mapping of legitimate web requests to expected database queries and comparing runtime traffic against that mapping. The comparison depends upon instrumentation installed on the protected system: Gupta describes that the instrumentation engine installs and monitors instrumented code on the web server or the application server executing the web application.

Amended claim 1 requires that the interrogation be performed in an agentless manner, without installing a monitoring agent on the servers hosting the databases. Removing Gupta's instrumentation removes the mechanism by which Gupta correlates requests to queries; the reference cannot be modified in the manner the rejection requires without destroying its principle of operation. *In re Ratti*, 270 F.2d 810 (CCPA 1959); *In re Gordon*, 733 F.2d 900 (Fed. Cir. 1984).

B. Neither reference discloses the neutralization step. Miller (US 2021/0216666, Pure Storage) is directed to detecting a security threat to a storage system by analyzing relationships between input/output operations, and responds through data-protection measures such as redundancy and recovery. It does not interrogate a database and does not act upon a live client connection. Gupta detects and then alerts or terminates a session; it does not alter a client SQL statement in flight. Amended claim 1 requires dynamically altering the structure of a client SQL statement of the offending connection while the threat is occurring, such that the client's operation is delayed. Neither reference, alone or in combination, discloses or suggests this step.

IV. Rejection of claim 9 under 35 U.S.C. § 103 further in view of Ratho

Ratho (US 2023/0305945, Amazon Technologies) is entitled "Tracking status of managed time series processing tasks." It concerns monitoring the execution status of time-series data processing tasks and generating human-readable explanations of task failures; its decision trees are

used to direct analysis of a failure and to map failure types to recommendations for machine-learning jobs.

Ratho is non-analogous art. It is not within the field of the inventor's endeavor, database security, and it is not reasonably pertinent to the problem addressed by the claimed invention, namely identifying and neutralizing security threats to databases. *In re Bigio*, 381 F.3d 1320 (Fed. Cir. 2004); *In re Klein*, 647 F.3d 1343 (Fed. Cir. 2011). A reference directed to reporting why a time-series processing job failed is not available as prior art against a claim to identifying database security problems.

Further, the articulated motivation, "the analogous concept of security detection associated with database and identifying security problems," presumes the very analogy that Ratho does not support. An obviousness rejection must be supported by reasoning with a rational underpinning. *KSR International v. Teleflex*, 550 U.S. 398, 418 (2007). Withdrawal of the rejection of claim 9 is respectfully requested.

V. Conclusion

Applicant submits that the pending claims are in condition for allowance and respectfully requests reconsideration and withdrawal of the rejections and objections. The Examiner is invited to telephone the undersigned should a call advance prosecution.

Respectfully submitted,

Meitar Patents Ltd.

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